



staircase with a sculptural steel centrepiece that feels more like a work of art than a utility.

Terracotta and Tradition

Design in Bengal is inseparable from its earth. The Barasat-Basirhat region is famous for its first-class kilns and the nearby archaeological site of Chandraketugarh, home to some of the world's earliest terracotta. It was only natural to let these local materials lead the way.



In keeping with the Baganbari tradition of spartan luxury, I curated the interiors with movable, multi-use furniture. This flexibility ensures the home remains maintenance-free and adaptable. A crowning jewel of the renovation is the Tulsi Mancha, commissioned in 2007 from sculptor Ramkumar Manna. This terracotta masterpiece is now recognised as one of the most unique in Bengal, serving as a spiritual and visual anchor for the property.

A Landscape Left Untouched

To me, the trees were the true architects of the land. Before laying a single stone for the driveway, I surveyed every existing trunk to ensure not a single tree would be felled. The resulting driveway is a deliberate, angular path lined with Ashoka trees that keeps the house hidden from view, building a sense of anticipation until you reach the Tulsi Mancha.

We also looked backward to move forward with sustainability. The rear of the property drains naturally into a pukur (pond), while the front directs water toward the roadside canal. We even integrated composting pits to keep the ecosystem self-sustaining.

Echoes of the 1950s

The charm of Ayesh lies in the layers of time. The gol ghar, a traditional thatched garden folly, has been a fixture here since the 1950s. We renew its thatch every five years, preserving the original railway benches and tables where Dr. Gazder and Satyajit Ray might have once discussed Bach or Beethoven. Even the caretaker's cottage, with its sloped tiled roofs reminiscent of an English country cottage, pays homage to this cross-cultural history.

In an era of rapid development, Ayesh Baganbari is a rare survivor. A bridge between the colonial sophistication of the 19th century and the ecological consciousness of 2026, it celebrates the quiet, the green, and the soulful.